IGNATIUS BOOK FAIRS

VIRTUAL BOOK FAIR CHECKLIST

Your step-by-step guide to a successful Catholic virtual book fair

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STEP 1 You Did It!

- [x] Choose Ignatius Book Fairs and set your virtual fair dates

  *You've already accomplished this step! Check out our **Resources** throughout this guide.*

STEP 2 Advertise Early & Often

- [ ] Advertising is the biggest predictor of success — you cannot over-advertise a virtual fair!
- [ ] Use your social media and email lists to spread the word; our Advertising Resources make it effortless
- [ ] Create your Book Fair Coordinator account
- [ ] Invite teachers to claim classrooms, make reading recommendations, and set up wish lists

  Confirm all teachers have logged in before parents start creating accounts

STEP 3 Share Links

- [ ] Distribute the Digital Flyer link to all parents and parishioners
- [ ] Share the Shopping Website link widely

STEP 4 Set a Sales Goal

- [ ] Set a sales goal and communicate it to your community

Sales	30% Ave Dollars
$1,000	$300
$2,000	$600
$3,000	$900

STEP 5 Display Sample Books

- [ ] If you ordered a sample box, set up books in the main foyer or a prominent location
- [ ] Make the display inviting: use the colorful tablecloth, add balloons or twinkle lights
- [ ] Add signage with fair dates and how the school benefits from orders

STEP 6 Fun Incentives

- [ ] Plan a fun event or incentive to get students excited: art contest, guessing game, reading day, or similar

  Prizes can be free books purchased with your Ave Dollars rewards

STEP 7 Receive & Distribute Orders

- [ ] Orders arrive labeled by customer name ~7–10 days after fair ends
- [ ] Distribute books or notify customers for pickup

STEP 8 Spend Your Rewards

- [ ] Log in to check your growing Ave Dollars balance (updates daily)
- [ ] Start spending rewards immediately — available right away

  Virtual fair rewards are in Ave Dollars only (not convertible to cash)

Advertising Schedule

- [ ] **7 weeks before:** Invite teachers to claim classrooms and create wish lists
  Videos: Create Coordinator Account • Invite Teachers
- [ ] **6 weeks before:** Post Save the Date on all social media, parish bulletin, and newsletter
- [ ] **5 weeks before:** Share this video on social media; include sign-up link for parents to create accounts
- [ ] **4 weeks before:** Post another Save the Date reminder with this graphic
- [ ] **3 weeks before:** Highlight select titles your staff or children enjoy; explain how sales benefit the school
- [ ] **2 weeks before:** Have principal or pastor send the Letter to Parents
- [ ] **1 week before:** Edit and send home the backpack flyer (1 per family)
  Can be inserted inside the catalog you receive
- [ ] **Evening before:** Post kickoff graphic on social media
  Videos: How to Create a Parent Account • How Orders Benefit Your School

During the Fair (Daily Posts)

- [ ] **Day 1:** Kick off with the Reading Challenge announcement
- [ ] **Day 2:** Post this graphic; remind community about free shipping to school during fair dates + online ordering link
- [ ] **Day 3:** Highlight reading recommendations by age/grade and teacher wish lists
- [ ] **Day 4:** Share staff top picks for fun, interesting, and thought-provoking books
- [ ] **Day 5:** Encourage "Stop, Drop and Read" — 20 min daily family reading habit
- [ ] **Day 6:** Thank supporters; ask for book recommendations from parents
- [ ] **Day 7:** Final day reminder — last chance to order; mention 30% earnings for school

FINAL

Have a Wonderful Virtual Book Fair!

Reach out to your Book Fair Manager if any issues arise — we're here to cheer you on and give you advice and support along the way!